Palestinian Liberation Theology owes the name to the Latin American movement, but while the latter bears a universal message of freedom for the oppressed, the Palestinian version is oriented to a particularist goal—liberating the Palestinian people from Israeli occupation. Thus, Palestinian theology in its ideological basis owes much more to neo-colonialist theories than to neo-Marxist economic theories.[24] Furthermore, replacement theology plays a pivotal role by expanding on the concepts of justice, the Promised Land, Israel, the "chosen people," and Christian love in this Palestinian national context.

Palestinian theologians call for justice, by which they mean the end of oppression by the Zionist regime. The very creation of the State of Israel is viewed as the result of the misdeeds of Europeans as perpetrators of the Holocaust. And the gravest sin of the Zionist state is the continuing occupation of the West Bank, which they see as a colonialist enterprise. Replacement theology enters in through Scripture reinterpreted so as to see Palestinians as a new Israel, and in addition, elements of anti-Judaism are advanced in a contemporary setting.

In references to the Exodus, the Zionist "usurper" is seen as the Egyptian Pharaoh, the Palestinians taking the place of the enslaved Hebrews.[25] Re-reading the Psalms on the Babylonian exile, Palestinian refugees see themselves as the dreamers for a return to their homeland.[26]

In considering the "Promised Land," Palestinian theologians endorse the notion of Jewish perfidy, and hold that the "Promised Land" is a spiritual concept, voided of its geographical and historical meaning, insofar as it is used as a Platonic "ideal place of peace and security."[27] Zionism can thus be accused of falsely interpreting Scripture inspired by its belief in the "Old Testament" God of wrath, violence, and war. The State of Israel is then understood as the product of a militaristic vision of God—antithetical to the "New Testament" God of peace.[28]

Many authors expressly reject any idea of Israel as a national community, especially one considered as a biblically "chosen people." Jewish thinkers are accused of holding a nationalistic, particularistic view of religion, superseded by the universalist God of the New Testament. Zionists (and their Christian supporters) are said to promote supremacist interpretations of the Bible that justify the "racist" Zionist regime, with a "narrow and primitive" concept of God that ignores the tradition of righteousness elaborated by the biblical prophets. Naim Ateek states that Zionism is "a step backward in the devlopment of Judaism," in that it builds upon nationalist views based on the concept of a "chosen people," whereby "ethical Judaism, with its universalist

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Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,